



VertiGO!!!

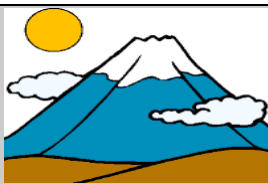
Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 709 July 2008 PO BOX 1 6 2 8 W E L L I N G T O N

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea and coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



The Hornley Arete



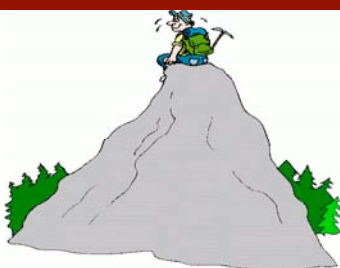
Section Night 7 July 2008

The Central Darran's - Climbing the faces of the peaks around Lake Turner in the Central Darran's has been the high point of Richard Thomson's climbing life.



Section Trip News

Please send all your fantastic trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.



TRIP REPORTS



Mt Tapuae-o-unuku

To take advantage of Queen's Birthday weekend, an 8-member party including H. Cox, S. Dowall, B. Fry, R. Geursen, L. Griffin, B. Hodge, A. Nevin, and K. Patterson hopped on the Friday night Interislander and struck out for an ascent of Tapuae-O-Uenuku (2884m) and Mt. Alarm (2877m). We tented on Friday night on farmland near the carpark (450m). The clear skies provided a spectacular night of star viewing and brisk temperatures. A leisurely Saturday saw us criss-crossing the Hodder River around 70 times to reach the Hodder huts (1440m). The river was quite low and easily navigable. Total time from the carpark to the huts was around 6 hours. Weather was sunny and warm. Sunday had excellent visibility, but inclement weather was apparent to the west. We broke up into two groups for a 5:30 start. Both groups followed the Staircase Stream to the basin beneath the south col. One group then continued up Tapi while the other party went directly to Alarm. Following the successful ascent of Tapi on thin, unlayered snow via the southwest ridge, that party made a traverse south of the 2711 gendarm to the south col and the followed the northeast ridge of Alarm. The first party had already summited via easy rock on the same ridge. The descent followed the same route as the ascent and was concluded by a casual hike back to the Hodder huts in the late afternoon. During the regress, a light snow began to fall. By the following day, a

few cm of snow had accumulated at the elevation of the huts. We retraced our route along the Hodder River back to the inviting bathtub sized pool in the lower Hodder by the carpark. All goals were accomplished.

Bill Fry



Crumbs from the Summer

Just after New Year Paul Maxim and John Nankervis climbed Ngatimamoe via the Northeast Ridge from a camp in Falls Creek. Good Darrans rock ?....hmmmm, not exactly. Cautionary tale: that's why it's in the Wick Mountains, not the Darrans. Later Paul and John turned back on the NW face of Rob Roy in "late season conditions" (euphemism for getting seriously off route). Earlier John with the extended Ellis whanau and John Cocks went climbing in the North Wilkin and got turned back on climbs graded with very small numbers, they claim cos of global warming and glacial retreat.

Later John joined up with young business partner, Phil Grover , to travel from Bainham to the Cobb including the high route on the spiky Dragons Teeth. Was this climbing ?...well it felt like it, so it was.

Over an extended Easter two Johns, Wild and Nankervis, went on a pilgrimage to Salt Lake City, to hear the Mormon Tabernacle Choir on Easter Sunday, to see the Utah Jazz play (NBA basketball) and to stock up on gear from the Black Diamond store. But while there they did sneak in some ski runs, including a few days touring in the deep pow between the Little and Big Cottonwood Canyons.

At Anzac weekend Federico Callegari and John Nankervis walked up the Travers valley and traversed Hopeless from north to south, Hopeless Creek to Cupola Basin. They insisted on carrying their three day swags over the top: some climbers never learn!

John Nankervis



CLASSIFIED



For Sale.....

BOOTS FOR SALE

Size: EUR 37

Style: Katmandu Womens Randonee 401 Tramping Boots

Description: Brown Leather - Hardly Worn - Excellent Condition

Price: \$120 (Paid \$300 new)
Phone: Vanessa (04) 562 7663



Wanted.....

If anybody has any alpine ski touring bindings they are looking to sell, or knows someone who does, could they please contact me at the details below?

(whether or not the skis are attached is by the by :))

Please contact Rachael Schmidt on 04 494 5658 or Rachael.Schmidt@crownlaw.govt.nz



For Loan.....

Loan a PLB (Personal Locator Beacon)

The club has three PLB's (emergency personal locator beacons). These are freely available to be borrowed by club members for use on club trips, instruction courses, and personal trips. If you wish to book one email Kevin at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, or call 934 0975 (h) or 027 687 9573.

Follow the following link to obtain a hire form and for more information on how to use a PLB - http://www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz/?page_id=303.



Wanted.....

Pro Bono Legal Service Request

With the Club's wealth of professional members, is there any lawyer out there who would be interested in helping out with some pro bono work for the National Office? Every now and then a legal question arises that we need a little help with. It would be great if there was a Club member we could go to who would be happy to volunteer a little of their time to assist. If you would like to be our go to person, please drop a line to Margaret@alpineclub.org.nz Thank you.



CLUB NOTICES



Ski Mountaineering Races 2008

EVENT DETAILS

Porters Dynafit Speed Up, Porter Heights Ski Area, July 26th

Dynafit Ski Mountaineering Clinic, Mt Cheeseman Ski Area, August 2nd

(<http://dynafit.co.nz/events.html>)

Rainbow Randonee Race, Rainbow Ski Area, August 9th

Manganui Randonee Race, Mt Taranaki, August 16th

Black Diamond Backcountry Blast, Ohau Ski Area, August 30th

Scarpa Craigieburner International Open, Craigieburn Ski Area, September 6th

Deuter Ruapehu Ripper, Turoa Ski Area, September 20th



New FMC Executive representative – Introducing Quentin Duthie

G'day folks. I represent you on the FMC executive along with Richard Davies also of the Wellington section.

Who am I? Well, I'm not a big climber, but my tramping extends well into the trans-alpine zone - the main thing is that I love to get into the hills as much as possible. I particularly love remote tramping huts and forgotten Fiordland ridges. With other helmets on I have a day-job as advisor to the Green Party (including on conservation, climate change and recreation), and I am a Green candidate in this year's general election. I have been member of VUWTC and WTMC in the recent past, and have a strong conservation ethic so am involved in Forest and Bird also.

<<http://www.greens.org.nz/election2008/people/QuentinDuthie.htm>>

Anyway, as an FMC executive member it is my responsibility to represent your interests. FMC advocates for recreation interests in the political and DOC management arenas, encourages debate and engagement via the Bulletin magazine (that you get sent with the Climber), and tries to help outdoor recreation clubs around the country sustain and grow themselves. If there are issues you are concerned about that FMC may be interested in or able to assist with, please contact me. As examples, FMC is currently watching the Walking Access Bill closely as it progresses through parliament, mountain areas in the South Island continue to be added to the conservation estate as a result of tenure review and lobbying in the past, FMC is opposed to the Mokihinui hydro dam near Kahurangi, and many other issues. We're volunteers so don't expect a miracle, but we're your volunteers so do expect to be listened to.



Topo50 Map Series Project

Land Information NZ are currently working on their Topo50 Map Series Project that will produce a 1:50,000 scale map series to replace the current Topographic NZMS260 one.

The new national map series will be launched in September 2009. If you would like further information, or to subscribe to LINZ for updates on the project please see their website: <http://www.linz.govt.nz/core/topography/projectsandprogrammes/topo50/index.html>

HAVE YOU GOT A JOB LINED UP FOR THE SUMMER?

THOUGHT ABOUT GLACIER GUIDING?

Imagine living at the foot of our country's highest mountains surrounded by wonderful West Coast forest. The best climbing, tramping, hunting, diving and fishing in New Zealand is right outside your back door.

This is an opportunity for you to live and work in a unique environment where glaciers, rainforest and the ocean meet. You will be guiding visitors from New Zealand and all over the world on the Fox Glacier.

You will work with one of New Zealand's oldest and most highly regarded adventure tourism operators, a caring and progressive company and have an opportunity for professional training with the New Zealand Mountain Guides Association.

If you wish to guide with us you will feel right at home in the outdoors ;be physically fit; have an outgoing and enthusiastic manner and enjoy talking to a wide range of people from all over the world.

Your initial contract would be for the period start October 2008 – end April 2009. However, depending on our needs and your level of enjoyment, an ongoing position may become available.

Applications will only be accepted on forms obtained from:

tracey@foxguides.co.nz

or
Fox Glacier Guiding
PO Box 38
Fox Glacier
Phone 03 7510 825
Fax 03 7510 857

View our website: www.foxguides.co.nz





ALPINE COURSES AND INSTRUCTION



Free climbing instruction and meets this winter

1. There are a couple of free technical climbing courses being held on Ruapehu this winter (basically the same as for last winter). These are for people who already have a grounding in using ice axes and crampons and are self sufficient on the mountain but want to get into pitched alpine climbing.
2. In August there is a climbing meet at Aoraki-Mt Cook National Park. This is to introduce climbers to big mountain climbing in winter conditions, which is something that rarely gets done in New Zealand. Climbers need to be experienced but not necessarily climbing high grades since there will be routes from grade 1-4 to choose from.
3. Later in August is the Darrans climbing meet that is being held by Al Walker and the Southland Section of the NZAC. This is to introduce climbers to technical mixed climbing in the country's best ice playground - the Darran Mountains.

More details can easily be found on the front page of the www.mountainz.co.nz site.



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Open 7 Days

Largest Real Rock Indoor Rock Wall – Kayaking – Inline Skates - Retail - Rental

Alpine Club Members with card can climb anytime for \$8.
Monday nights show your members card and climb for \$5.



CLUB TRIPS



AND HERE ARE THE CLUB TRIPS

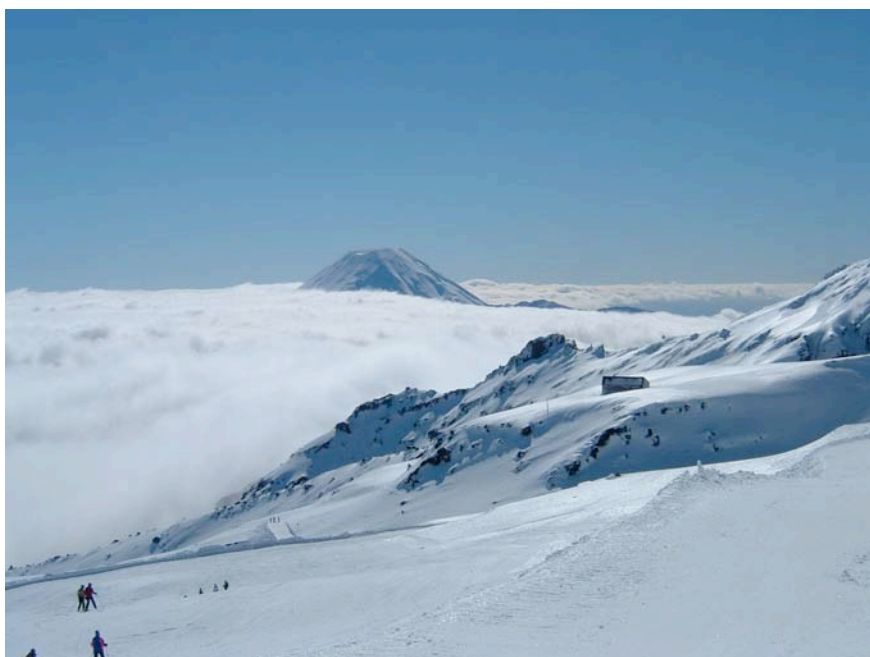
Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the section, so if anyone has an idea about a trip, no matter how vague, send an email to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz).

Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us, or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going.

18-20Jul08 - Ruapehu North - Te Heu Heu, Dome, and Paretetaitonga – Leader – Steve Merchant Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

The plan is to drive up to Whakapapa, and climb up to Delta Corner Hut on Friday night. On Saturday we will stroll up to the crater, inspect the Dome shelter (2672m) and attempt Paratetaitonga (2751m), returning to Delta Corner for the evening. On Sunday we will return to the crater and attempt Te Heu Heu (2732m) along the main ridge, descending the skifield to the car park and home thereafter. Contact Steve Merchant, ph 021 272 1151, or email me at smerchant@clear.net.nz.



North Ruapehu with the NZAC hut, Pinnacles, and Ngarauhoe

22-24Aug08 - Ruapehu South - Girdlestone and Tahurangi – Leader TBA – Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

On Friday night we will drive up to Ohakune and either tent near the mountain road or stay at the backpackers. Saturday we will ascend the highest point on Ruapehu = Tahurangi peak (2797m) returning for a pub meal at the Powderhorn in the evening. On Sunday we will attempt Girdlestone (2658m), the outlying peak on the right of Tahurangi by crossing the Mangaehuehu Glacier. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.



Ruapehu Crater Lake

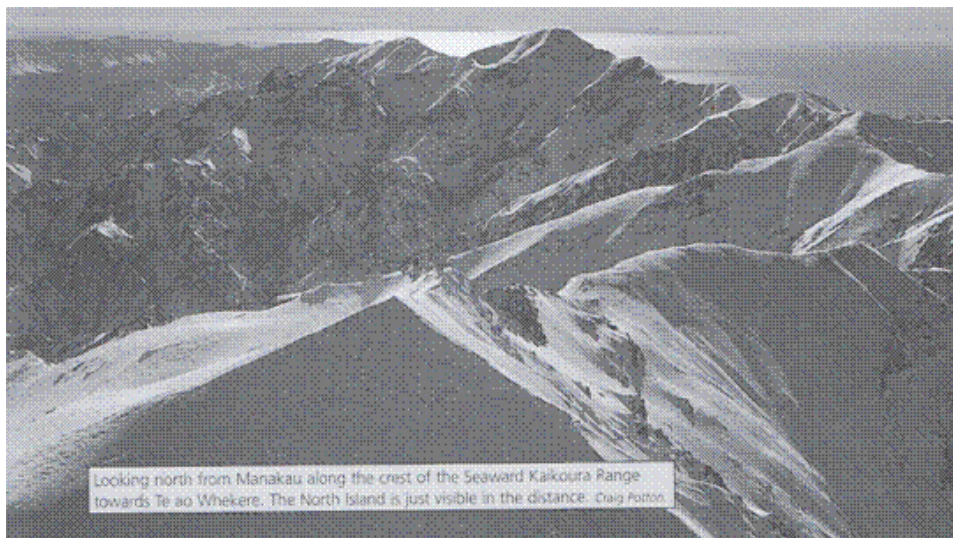
19-21Sep08 - Egmont - via Tahurangi lodge – Leader TBA – Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

We will leave early on Friday afternoon (4pm) to North Egmont car park, from where we will tramp up to Tahurangi Lodge (1.5h) arriving ca. 11pm. On Saturday we will ascend Egmont (2518m) via the Lizard, returning to the lodge for the evening. On Sunday we will explore the rock walls of Warwick Castle (bring a rope for this trip) towards the eastern side before returning to the car park. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.



***Mt Egmont Crater Wall 24-27Oct08 – Mt Manukau – Seaward Kaikouras – Labour Weekend -
Leader James Wright – Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience***

Spring snow trip to end the northern alpine season! Come on this challenging 3 day climb in the Seaward Kaikouras. On Friday night we'll take the ferry and stay near the road end. Saturday will be the trip in up the Manaukau River followed by a climb up to a high Alpine basin where we'll tent overnight. On Sunday we'll attempt the summit via the north ridge. No ropes required. Contact James at 232 7748 or by email at james.wright@xtra.co.nz



Te Ao Whakere from the summit of Mt Manakau



SPECIAL THANKS

Thank you to Committee Members

Our thanks are extended to **Hayden Cox**, **Paul Grimwood** and **Jen Brown** who have recently resigned from the Wellington Section. They have all contributed in various roles to help keep the Section running.

Special thanks to Garth London

Garth recently resigned his role as Chairperson of the Section. Garth has been a dedicated stalwart of this Club and Committee. Those of us who are left have rapidly realised the extent of the work he did as we all attempt to fill the gap. We wish him and Angie well in their new work ventures in Auckland.

New Committee Members

If anyone out there is keen to learn a bit about running the Section then please get in touch. It is not onerous with plenty of people helping. Meetings are once a month and there is plenty of experience to help newcomers learn. Please contact **Rachel Depree** (rd@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz) or **Catherine Moger** (cm@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz) or any other Committee Member.

ALSO GOES TO:

I wanted to add a note to thank **James Wright** who decided the committee should actively look to decrease the number of paper copies of **VertiGo** posted each month to members. He organised committee members to each call a small number of members who receive paper copies of **VertiGo** to see whether they would mind moving onto the list of members who receive electronic copies of our monthly Newsletter.

As a result, we have managed to reduce the number of paper copies printed and posted each month from 200 to only 80! Not only does this help our environment but it has also reduced our monthly Newsletter cost from about \$220 a month to approximately \$100.

So Thanks James!

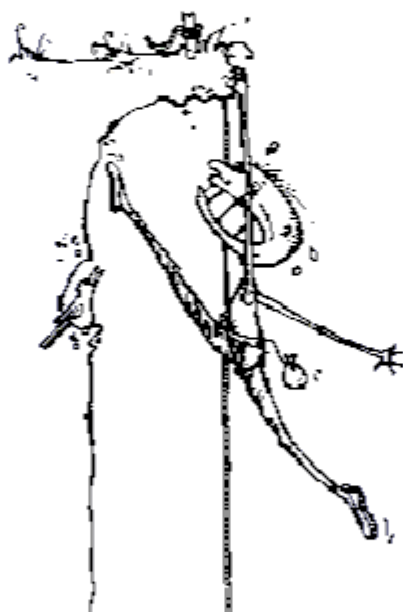
If you currently receive a paper copy and would like to move onto the electronic mailing list then please email admin@alpineclub.org.nz <<mailto:admin@alpineclub.org.nz>> or look on our website www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz under the Monthly Newsletter page.



WELLINGTON SECTION: 2008 CONTACT LIST

Position	Name	E-mail Alias*	Phone
Chairperson	VACANT		
Vice Chairperson	VACANT		
Secretary	Rachel Depree	SECRETARY <i>or</i> RD	N/A
Treasurer	Karen Domaneschi	TREASURER <i>or</i> KD	N/A
National Representative	James Wright	JW	N/A
	Judy Reid	JR	
Instruction: AIC	VACANT	AIC	N/A
Instruction: RIC	Blair Hiscoke	SPRINGROCK	N/A
National Instruction Rep	VACANT		N/A
Drill Overseer	Kristen Foley	KF	N/A
Trips	Kevin Patterson	TRIPS <i>or</i> KP	N/A
	Gwen Rashbrooke	TRIPS <i>or</i> GR	N/A
Library	Derek Richardson	LIBRARY	N/A
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	N/A
Committee Members	VACANT		N/A
	VACANT		N/A
	VACANT		N/A
	Blair Hiscoke	BH	N/A
	Louise Thornley	LT	N/A
	James Wright	JW	027 472 5561
	Catherine Moger	CM2	N/A
Newsletter Editor	Jo Langridge	NEWSLETTER <i>or</i> JL	N/A
Webmeister	Jane Furkert	WEBMASTER <i>or</i> JF	N/A
National President	Phil Doole		N/A

* Email address is alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, eg: secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



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Wellington

